

SFPA Spring 2026 City Championship

Title Odds — Tournament Projection

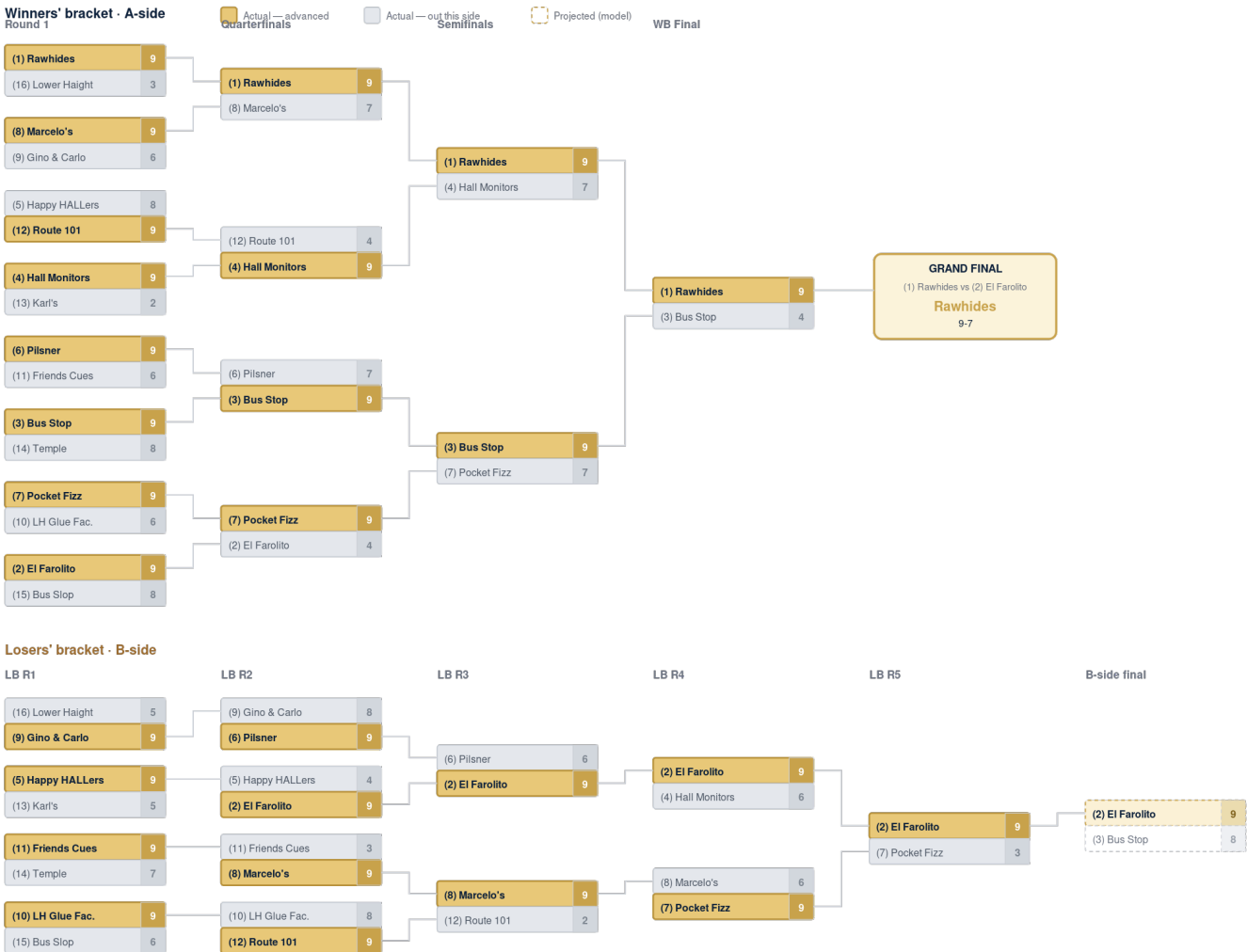
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Rawhides are the favorite to win the City Championship at **91%**, ahead of a tight chase between **El Farolito** (6%) and **Bus Stop** (3%). Together the top three hold about 100% of all title equity; below them the field falls off sharply.

Team	Seed	Title %	Reach Grand Final
Happy Lounge Rawhides	1	91.1%	100%
El Farolito Shooters	2	6.4%	59%
Bus Stop Flyers	3	2.5%	41%
Hall Monitors	4	0.0%	0%
Happy HALLers	5	0.0%	0%
Pilsner InnDecisives	6	0.0%	0%
Pocket Full of Fizz	7	0.0%	0%
Marcelo's Hall Stars	8	0.0%	0%
Gino & Carlo	9	0.0%	0%
Lucky Horseshoe Glue Factory	10	0.0%	0%
Friends Crooked Cues	11	0.0%	0%
Route 101 Dalmatians	12	0.0%	0%
Karl's Freakin' Beacon	13	0.0%	0%
Temple Holy Smokes	14	0.0%	0%
Bus Slop	15	0.0%	0%
Lower Haight Misfits	16	0.0%	0%

Projected Bracket

Single most-likely path through the 16-team double elimination. Lose on the A-side (winners') and you drop to the B-side (losers'); a second loss ends your run. The B-side survivor must beat the A-side finalist twice. **Grand Final:** (1) Rawhides vs (2) El Farolito — champion **Rawhides** (9-7).



The state of play

For all the model's confidence in the favorite, this has been the opposite of a chalk tournament. Rawhides have held up their end — still a commanding **91.1%** to win it — but everything behind them has been chaos: a #2 seed knocked out early, the six-season Pilsner dynasty gone, a 12-seed Cinderella in Route 101, and a 7-seed in Pocket Fizz that flatly refuses to read the seed lines. With the field down to **3**, the bracket has split into two very different movies.

On the A-side it's coronation-or-spoiler: **Rawhides sit one win from the hot seat**, with only Bus Stop in the way — and four seasons of history saying Rawhides own that matchup when it counts (**5-1** all-time, and a perfect **2-0** in the playoffs). On the B-side it's a survival gauntlet: **El Farolito**, the fallen 2-seed, is trying to claw all the way back — and runs straight into **Pocket Fizz**, the very team that knocked them down in the first place. A revenge rematch with a season on the line.

What keeps it tense even with a heavy favorite is the double-elimination math. Rawhides need just two wins and carry a safety net at every step; whoever emerges from the losers' bracket has to run the table and then beat the A-side finalist *twice*. Two wins with insurance versus five must-wins through a gauntlet — that asymmetry is the whole tournament in a sentence. For the trophy to change hands, somebody's long shot has to hit.

Last Round's Results: Winners' Bracket Final + Losers' Bracket R5

The winners'-bracket final is done, and it wasn't close: Rawhides dropped Bus Stop 9-4, punching a ticket straight to the grand final with the double-elimination cushion every team in this draw has been chasing since the seeds came out. The model had this coming — Rawhides was already a 79.2% favorite — but a win this size still moves the number: title odds jump to 91.1%, up 11.9 points from a week ago.

Look at the box score and the match tells its own story. For Rawhides, Kevin Scheper went a perfect 3-0, while across the table Bus Stop stayed in the fight early — Wade Hargrove led the way at 2-2. It caught up with them in the end, though: Justin Anderson never got on the board, going 0-3, and the bottom of the lineup is exactly where Rawhides bracket-favorite depth is supposed to show up.

The undercard carried its own gut-punch. El Farolito eliminated Pocket Fizz 9-3 to end their season, and Otoniel Jimenez went a perfect 3-0. The cruelest detail belongs to the losing side: Albert Yip and Clayton Lapointe were held scoreless, a combined 0-for-6 — on the night their season ended.

3 teams remain. Bus Stop drops to the losers'-bracket final to face El Farolito — the winner of that one earns a single shot at Rawhides, and it comes with the cruelest condition in the sport: a true reset, meaning they have to beat the top seed twice in a row to take the title.

Result	Model predicted	Actual
(1) Rawhides def. (3) Bus Stop	Rawhides 9-6	9-4
(2) El Farolito def. (7) Pocket Fizz	El Farolito 9-6	9-3

Model-predicted score (favorite and expected margin) vs. the actual result. Shaded rows mark a match the model's pick lost; winner's game count shown first.

Looking Ahead

The losers'-bracket final — El Farolito vs Bus Stop

The one-loss bracket crowns its champion. El Farolito and Bus Stop both have exactly one path left, and it runs through each other first: win this and you earn the right to chase the top seed through a true-reset grand final — beating them twice in a row, with nothing in the bank. Lose, and the season's over tonight.

They've actually met once already, and it settled nothing. Back in the regular season, Bus Stop and El Farolito played to an 8-8 tie — dead level, 8 games apiece — the one result on the schedule that refused to pick a side. Now, with a season on the line and ties off the table (this is race-to-9, sudden death), somebody finally has to blink.

Both arrive hot off wins that tell very different stories. El Farolito bulldozed a way here off elimination games; Bus Stop just got run off the winners'-bracket floor by the top seed and now has to prove that loss was a blip, not a trend. The model gives El Farolito 59% for the match — 53% per game, effective Fargo 569 to 553 — but this bracket has made a habit of ignoring the model.

Playoff Standouts

The bracket is a team game, but somebody has to make the balls. A look at who's carrying the load for the teams still standing — the players quietly (and not so quietly) winning their matches within the match.

Standout of the round

No one has been better with the season on the line. Steven Waldon has gone **9-2** in the playoffs — a **82%** win rate, the best of any regular still standing. The winners'-bracket final was the first time all playoffs he's actually lost a rack in a match he still won — Bus Stop's Wade Hargrove caught him in the opener — but Waldon answered by running the table to beat Justin Anderson and closing it out again over Tom Purcell, going **2-1** as Rawhides put Bus Stop away 9-4 and walked into the grand final. That's the Waldon pattern: even his rare off-night still ends in a win. If the grand final ever comes down to a single deciding game, he's exactly who the Rawhides want stepping to the table.

Player	Team	Playoff W-L	Win %	Table runs
Steven Waldon	Rawhides	9-2	82%	2
Otoniel Jimenez	El Farolito	12-6	67%	2
Wade Hargrove	Bus Stop	8-4	67%	—
Kevin Scheper	Rawhides	9-5	64%	—
Bob Simon	Rawhides	7-4	64%	1
Tom Purcell	Bus Stop	9-6	60%	1
Perez Vallarta	El Farolito	8-6	57%	1
Rene Loria	Bus Stop	8-8	50%	—

Individual game record across the playoff weeks, for players on teams still alive (min. 6 games). Table runs = racks won from the break without the opponent reaching the table.

Hottest hands this week: Otoniel Jimenez (El Farolito) 3-0; Kevin Scheper (Rawhides) 3-0.

Playoff Performance Ratings

A performance rating answers a different question than a win-loss record: *how good did you actually play?* We take every individual game a player played this playoff run, look up each opponent's Fargo, and solve for the rating at which their win total is exactly what you'd expect. Beat a 500-rated player at a 4-2 clip and you performed like a 600. It rewards beating strong opponents and doesn't punish anyone for a tough draw — the ultimate opponent-adjusted scoreboard.

Top performer — 759

And nobody in the tournament has played at a higher level than **Steven Waldon**. Against playoff competition averaging **542** Fargo, his 7-1 run computes to an **759 performance rating** — a staggering **+155 over his own 604 rating**, and the single highest performance mark of anyone in the field (the next-best is 730). Put plainly: a very good 604-rated player spent the playoffs playing like an elite 800+. That's not a hot streak against soft competition — his opponents averaged 542 — it's the best pool anyone in this City Championship has played.

Player	Team	W-L	Avg opp	Fargo	Performance	vs rating
Steven Waldon	Rawhides	9-2	542	604	759	+155
Khanh Ngo	Marcelo's	8-2	521	583	730	+147
Prithiv Kumar	Hall Monitors	9-2	487	544	719	+175
Antonio Cracchiolo	Hall Monitors	8-2	492	578	707	+129
Joshua Maldonado	Rawhides	3-1	535	591	695	+104
Wade Hargrove	Bus Stop	8-4	542	552	644	+92
Willie Gregory	Marcelo's	5-2	478	561	616	+55
Nithin Tharakan	Marcelo's	9-5	512	525	601	+76
Bob Simon	Rawhides	7-4	505	543	591	+48
Otoniel Jimenez	El Farolito	12-6	489	627	589	-38
Tom Purcell	Bus Stop	9-6	524	515	583	+68
Albert Yip	Pocket Fizz	6-4	492	487	551	+64
Perez Vallarta	El Farolito	8-6	499	537	540	+3

Performance = the Fargo level a player performed at across the playoffs, from opponent-weighted results (players on teams still alive, min. 6 games). "vs rating" is performance minus their own Fargo.

Team Elo — Overall Strength

Each team's strength rating: the Fargo of their best playoff lineup, adjusted for season form, plus a data-tested pedigree where earned. Higher = stronger. This is what drives the title odds.

Rank	Team	Team Elo	Top-4 Fargo	Title %
1	Happy Lounge Rawhides	1702	609.5	91.1%
2	Pilsner InnDecisives	1632	539.0	0.0%
3	Hall Monitors	1620	567.0	0.0%
4	El Farolito Shooters	1605	548.0	6.4%
5	Marcelo's Hall Stars	1598	553.8	0.0%
6	Bus Stop Flyers	1594	550.5	2.5%
7	Pocket Full of Fizz	1526	515.0	0.0%
8	Happy HALLers	1509	503.8	0.0%
9	Temple Holy Smokes	1508	513.2	0.0%
10	Gino & Carlo	1502	505.2	0.0%
11	Friends Crooked Cues	1454	478.0	0.0%
12	Route 101 Dalmatians	1412	455.8	0.0%
13	Lucky Horseshoe Glue Factory	1401	453.8	0.0%
14	Bus Slop	1378	443.2	0.0%
15	Karl's Freakin' Beacon	1363	431.8	0.0%
16	Lower Haight Misfits	1317	409.8	0.0%

How These Numbers Were Built

1. A rating based on who actually plays. Each team is rated by its players' Fargo (skill) ratings — but performance is judged against the lineup it *actually fielded* each match, not its best-case roster. If a team rests a star or plays a weaker substitute who performs at their own level, the model doesn't punish them: it expected less, and got it. When a 405-rated depth player loses most of his games to 600-rated opponents, that's neutral, not a black mark. Most rating systems can't tell "played badly" from "fielded a weaker lineup" — this one can, because it reads every individual player's result in every match.

2. Win probabilities — and proof they work. Playoff matches are a race to 9 (a 9-3 match ends after 12 games). The Fargo gap between the two lineups sets each game's odds, capped at 75/25 since pool has too much variance for locks; at 8-8 a single deciding game is played between each team's top player. We back-tested the engine on this season: it correctly called **76.5% of 251 matches** (Brier score 0.154), with well-calibrated confidence — the basis for trusting the odds.

3. 60,000 simulated tournaments. The full double-elimination bracket is played 60,000 times; every number in this report — the title odds and the projected bracket — comes from that one simulation, so they're mutually consistent.

4. A data-tested pedigree for Pilsner. Rather than guess at a "dynasty" weight, we tested it: across four seasons of playoff results, Pilsner's record is 4-season playoff record 17-7 (71%), and every loss came against Rawhides — against everyone else they are a perfect 15-0. That overperformance is statistically real ($p < 0.05$), so Pilsner carries a measured +30 Fargo playoff bump. No other team earned one; Rawhides' four titles are the best team doing what it should, already in its rating.

Every adjustment has a number behind it, not a feel. Pool is high-variance — treat these as probabilities, not predictions; even a clear favorite loses far more often than it wins.

Appendix — Season Form

A supporting metric, not a strength rating: did a team beat or miss its own roster's Fargo expectation this season, match by match? A strong team can show negative form if it underplayed its talent.

Team	Season Form	vs roster
El Farolito Shooters	+28.0	overachieved
Happy HALLers	+17.2	overachieved
Route 101 Dalmatians	+14.4	overachieved
Karl's Freakin' Beacon	+13.9	overachieved
Friends Crooked Cues	+11.6	overachieved
Lower Haight Misfits	+10.8	overachieved
Pocket Full of Fizz	+8.1	overachieved
Pilsner InnDecisives	+4.9	~ as expected
Lucky Horseshoe Glue Factory	+4.0	~ as expected
Bus Stop Flyers	+3.5	~ as expected
Gino & Carlo	+2.4	~ as expected
Bus Slop	+1.6	~ as expected
Marcelo's Hall Stars	+0.1	~ as expected
Hall Monitors	-7.3	underachieved
Happy Lounge Rawhides	-10.4	underachieved

Team	Season Form	vs roster
Temple Holy Smokes	-13.5	underachieved